the present atmosphere in the country will not lead to wanton acts of revenge. Like everything else, discipline in the army seems rather loose.

A former student of mine just posted a heart-wrenching message: members of his family were killed and others taken hostage in the Nir Oz kibbutz. He rightly places part of the responsibility where it should be placed: on the shoulders of the prosettler coalition that has been in charge these past few months. As for Hamas, nobody doubts that they are killers who, on top of their own murderous ideology, made the most of the poisonous atmosphere created by the settlers and their supporters. I am afraid that many people in Israel, even those who participated in the demonstrations against the government, will forget the noxious role played by the coalition and will call for revenge against Palestinians in general. The Americans, Biden, Lloyd Austin, and Blinken, are aware of the explosive atmosphere and call for firmness but warn against revenge. May they be heard.

In the last two days, several articles published in Israeli newspapers have expressed a deep pessimism about the future of our relations with the Palestinians (David Grossman in *Haaretz*, two days ago) and about the future of Israel as we have known it, of the ethos that we dreamed of (Nahum Barnea, today). Both attach the responsibility that should be attached to our horrendous government. I hope that we will have a chance to say to those freaks' faces what must be said. Grossman used the right expression: treason by the government, letting down the people they were in charge of. The key word is "treason."

According to research by CNN, Hamas prepared the attack for months, a few hundred meters from the Gaza border, in constructions that replicated the Israeli border fence and the southern communities in great detail. How these preparations escaped the attention of our wonderful military intelligence is even more incomprehensible than ever. According to the *New*